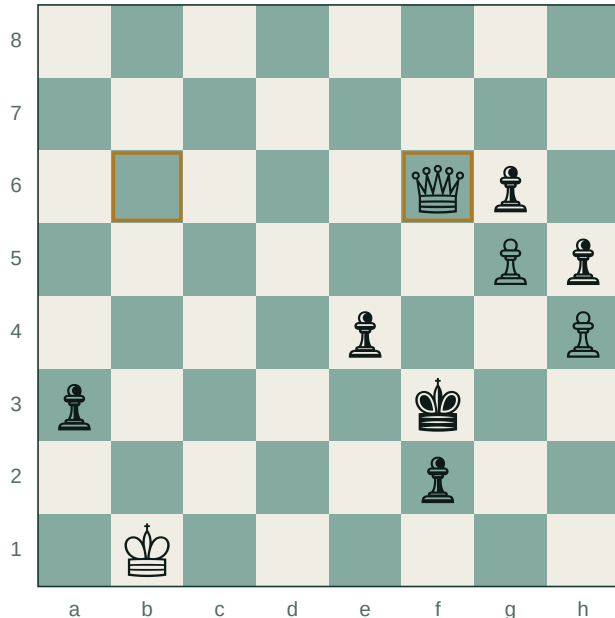


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 51

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 51.Qf6+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

51...Kg2 52. Qc6 f1=Q+

51...Kg2 The king moves from f3 to g2. Recorded reply: **52.Qc6**.

52...f1=Q+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from -6 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on b1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.